

Introduction to Course Bidding

Undergraduate Course Enrolment: Monsoon 2026

From **Monsoon 2026**, elective enrolment moves from First-Come-First-Served to a **bid-point system** on the new enrolment platform. This notice sets out how bidding works and the sequence of rounds. Details regarding the schedule, and how your bid points are allocated will be shared in a few days.

1. What is changing

Bidding replaces the race to register. Instead of outcomes depending on how quickly you click when the portal opens, you receive a pool of bid points for each elective category and use them, across a fixed sequence of rounds, to bid for the courses you want. Seats are awarded on the strength of your bids, not your speed.

Bidding applies to the three elective categories:

- **Major Electives (ME)** — electives within your major; the number of bid points allocated varies by programme.
- **University-Wide Electives (UWE)** — electives open across the University.
- **Common Core Courses (CCC)** — electives common to all programmes.

Core and other mandatory degree-completion courses are **pre-enrolled for you and sit outside bidding**.

2. How your bid points are allocated

You get a separate bucket of bid points for each of the three categories – Major Elective, UWE, and CCC. Bid points are released in a staggered manner over the duration of the program.

- **Transition support.** The third- and fourth-year batches planned much of their degree under FCFS, so they also receive a higher proportion of bid points. Senior batches keep the advantage the old day-staggered system gave them. Points track the credits each third / fourth year student **still need to graduate** in each category. This is a one-time transition support for the batch of 2027 and 2028 only, from the second-year batch onwards, the steady-state allocation will apply. Exact details on the bid points allocation will be shared later.
- **Floater credits.** Points from your pending Floater credits are split equally between UWE and CCC.
- **Carry-forward.** Points you do not spend are not lost — they carry forward to your future bidding semesters.

3. How bidding works

Within each bidding round you build a set of the courses you want, place your bids, and can adjust them until the round closes:

- **Swapping Major Core Groups.** In the first round, you will have an option to swap your groups for major core (wherever applicable). The swaps will be executed on random sequencing basis, if two-way swap requests are feasible. This may allow you to free-up slots for courses you are interested in.
- **Placing a bid.** When you add a course, the system fills in the minimum bid at Zero points for the course. You can raise your bid to compete or keep it at zero. You also set preferences across course groups and priorities that are used if two of your courses' clashes.
- **What you can see.** While a round is open you see, for each course, the number of seats, and the number of bidders, alongside your own bid — and may revise until the round closes. You do not see other students' individual bids.

- **How seats are won.** Seats go to the strongest bids. Ties are settled by a random draw-based tie breaker. Where you bid across several course groups, your most-preferred winning group is allotted; where courses clash, your higher-priority course.
- **One clearing price per course.** Everyone who wins a course pays the same clearing price — the lowest winning bid (or zero bid points if seats remain) — not the amount they bid.
- **Settlement.** After the round closes, if you win a course the clearing price is deducted and the rest of your points refunded; if you do not win, all your points are refunded.
- **Eligibility checks.** A course cannot clash with your pre-enrolled core, and at most one clash is allowed within your set of choices; prerequisites must be met; and semester and graduation credit limits apply (you may bid for backups up to twice your available credit limit). A student cannot take two or more courses from the mutually exclusive groups (equivalent courses).

4. The rounds and schedule

Enrolment runs as a fixed sequence of rounds — swap, bidding, waitlist and add/drop. Each open and closes at a set time, and you can act only while a round is open.

Round	Stage
1	Major Core — Swap
2	Major Elective — Bidding
3	Major Elective — Drop Round
4	CCC / UWE — Bidding (I)
5	Major Core — Swap
6	CCC / UWE — Bidding (II)
7	Major Elective — Waitlist
8	CCC / UWE — Waitlist
9	Add / Drop

Half-semester CCC courses have a further set of second-half rounds (CCC bidding, waitlist and add/drop) later in the semester; those dates will be announced separately.

5. Key points and support

- The 25-credit maximum per semester is unchanged; higher bid points cannot be used to corner seats.

This is the first of the multiple announcements that will follow on course bidding and registration.

After the webinar trainings sessions, a mock live bidding will be organized in the first week of August. We will also be setting up a dedicated helpdesk for all your queries and questions.

Best Wishes,
Ankur Mehra, PhD